

2.3.4 Rest

To use an earlier point we made, remember that the PowerPoint presentation isn't your master—it's the other way round. Very few speakers realise they can pause for a while. A pause gives the speaker as well as the audience breathing room. When we say "pause," you might also let the screen go blank—it can then be a pause in the true sense of the word. But it will not happen if you inherently believe that *you* are supplementing *the presentation*.

Pauses are useful for more than "breathing room" as in relaxation. They also augment recall. The members of the audience get time to reflect upon what you've said and what's been presented, they get time to formulate questions, they get time to subconsciously imbibe what has been presented thus far.

2.3.5 Flow

Attempt to conduct the presentation in such a way that one point leads to another, one slide leads to another. Actually, this should have been done when you were ideating your slides (remember?), but here we're saying that it should reflect in the way you speak.

Give your presentation a narrative quality; in simple words, tell a story. Wisdom has become knowledge has become information, true. But a story may be made from information as well. Begin with a brief introduction—which everybody does—but also include an outline, which not everybody does.

Your slides should not be independent of each other. That's something you've got to plan right in the beginning—they must each lead into the next. In the case that they don't do that neatly, you don't want the audience faced with something they didn't expect—so if you are indeed going to switch gears, inform the audience about that before the slide advances.

Now, use connecting words as the slides change... for example, if slide #1 shows sales figures (the world's favourite slide example), and slide #2 displays a trend, connect the two with "*However*, we